

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 8 3
 ♥ J 9 6 5
 ♦ 9 3
 ♣ K Q 5 2

♠ Q 4

♥ Q 10 7

♦ A J 6

♣ A 10 9 8 6



♠ 10 7 2

♥ 2

♦ K Q 10 8 4 2

♣ J 7 3

♠ K J 9 6 5

♥ A K 8 4 3

♦ 7 5

♣ 4

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	2NT	Pass	3 ♥
Pass	4 ♥		
All Pass			
Lead: ♦ 9			

South opens 1 ♠. So far you know you belong in game, but you don't know which game. What do you bid first? You respond 2 ♣, natural and forcing the partnership to game. South now bids his ♥ suit. At this point you figure South for 5 ♠s and 4 ♥s. What should you rebid? You cannot support either of South's Majors, but with a good stopper in the fourth suit you bid 2NT. The game force is still on and South may not pass this bid. South bids 3 ♥, indicating that this is also a 5-card suit. What do you rebid now?

Now you can bid the ♥ game, knowing there is an 8-card fit.

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 8 3
 ♥ 8 2
 ♦ 10 8 2
 ♣ A K J 10 8

♠ A J 10 7 4

♥ K 10 7

♦ A 9 5

♣ 7 2



♠ K Q 2

♥ J 6 4

♦ J 7 4

♣ 6 5 4 3

♠ 6 5

♥ A Q 9 5 3

♦ K Q 6 3

♣ Q 9

West	North	East	South
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	3 ♥	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			
Lead: ♣K			

What do you open with this hand? You opens 1 ♠ and South, responds 2 ♥. Note that this promises a 5-card or longer ♥ suit. (2 of a minor only promises 4+). What do you rebid? Knowing that South has 5, you bid 3 ♥ to confirm the trump suit. South bids 4 ♥.

South went straight to game, showing a minimum opener and no slam interest. You are also satisfied to just play at game. 2/1 is a good bidding method, and here, 4 ♥ is a good contract. But you can see that it is not a laydown - there is no bidding system that will always reach 100% contracts. In this hand a 3-3 ♦ split will provide the 10th trick, or if that fails, taking 2 ♠ finesses provides a 75% chance of success.

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 10 8

♥ J 4

♦ A 10 9 8 5 3

♣ 7 4

♠ 7

♥ A K 7 5

♦ K 7 6 2

♣ K Q 10 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 4 3

♥ Q 6 2

♦ Q J

♣ J 9 5 3 2

♠ A K 9 6 5 2

♥ 10 9 8 3

♦ 4

♣ A 8

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

2♣

Pass

2♥

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

Lead: ♣7

South opens 1♠. You have 15 HCP, but you only have 4♥s, so you can't bid 2♥ (this would promise a 5-card suit). So instead you bid clubs. This is natural and game-forcing, but only promises 4+ clubs. Note that holding two 4-card minors you bid them up-the-line, just as in standard bidding. South rebids 2♥. This shows at least 4 hearts. What do you rebid now? Your 3♥ bid confirms hearts as trump. There's no worry partner might pass - we are in a game forcing auction. South raises to 4♥, showing no slam interest.

We don't have enough for slam opposite a minimum opener, so we just pass. Note South's decision to show the poor 4-card heart suit for their second bid, instead of showing the 6th spade. In a GF sequence, it's more important to tell about 4 more cards than 1 more card. South will always have the chance to rebid spades later if there is no heart fit.

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ J 6 4

♥ 7 5

♦ 6 3

♣ A Q 10 4 3 2

♠ 8 7 5

♥ K 4

♦ A Q J 10 7

♣ K 9 7



♠ Q 10 3

♥ J 10 6 2

♦ K 9 4 2

♣ J 5

♠ A K 9 2

♥ A Q 9 8 3

♦ 8 5

♣ 8 6

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

2♦

Pass

2♠

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

Lead: ♣J

South opens 1♥ - how do you respond? South next bids 2♠, showing the other Major suit. In standard bidding this is a Reverse, showing a strong hand with 5♥s and 4♠s. But after a 2/1 GF response, South doesn't need extra values to show their 4-card spade suit. What should you rebid? You assume South to be 4-5 in the Majors, and since you can't support either one, you bid 2NT. If South actually has 6♥s (or 5♠s) he would rebid the suit. Your 2NT bid guarantees a stopper in the fourth suit.

South does not have either 6♥s or 5♠s so he just bids 3NT. Notice that South never once considered the possibility of passing what might be a misfit - the initial 2/1 response unconditionally forced the partnership to reach a game somewhere.